He pushed a button and the screen went dark. His mother fell silent.

'Coming.'

He often plays back this recording and he feels as if he is walking again with his mother on the Moon, looking down at his native planet. Their group had gone off to another galaxy after all: they had left their native Sun, which was now just a 12th - magnitude star, visible through the telescope. And they couldn't see the Earth at all.

Why had they gone? Because they were young. And humanity is young.

Glossary

EYHVKU

chore (n) - a routine task, especially a household one

orchard (n) - a piece of enclosed land planted with fruit trees

expedition (n) - a journey undertaken by a group of people with a particular purpose, especially that of exploration, research, or war

quartz (n) - a hard, transparent mineral substance, used in making electronic equipment

exotic (adj.) - unusual and exciting

void (n) - a completely empty space

confronted (v) - to face, meet, or deal with a difficult situation or person

departure (n) - the action of leaving, especially to start a journey

pears (n) - a sweet, juicy, yellow or green fruit with a round base and slightly pointed top

galaxy (n) - one of the large, independent groups of stars in the universe

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